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Project Title: 8:12 Theory
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Analyst: Scott Parisien
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Project Logline

A structural engineer dealing with the heavy loss of his wife and daughter finds the city of Bangkok and the buildings he investigates hold clues that could lead him to the truth and secrets behind his trauma.

Intro

First of all, Jeremy, thank you for submitting your television bible document for our review. What you have here is a very detailed breakdown of exactly what you see, the overall understanding, and the episode timeline for this science-fiction and supernatural-based journey. Your leading character seems to underestimate himself, does not quite know the power he holds, and is dealing with a lot of grief over this major loss. It hints that the idea of this being a supernatural realm, and maybe not even a real world. For all we know, he could be in a coma somewhere, as though he was part of an accident, and this is him living through this journey. It leaves it very mysterious, opens up a lot of doors and opportunities to take what is here and really grow it into something quite wild.

In your submission note, you mentioned that this is designed for selling, so that is where I'm going to focus. It's not as much about what the different elements will be in the pilot or what that series might look like. You clearly have a history and some experience with your journey through this, your connection with Netflix, and getting other series sold or set up in the past. I will then focus on how it hits me as a reader, and possibly through that investor or producer lens as well. This can let you know, organically, how certain things came to me, what they made me think, and how I felt throughout the overall experience of moving through this bible. I hope that will give you what you need and help you move forward with this.

Analysis

I'll start by saying this is a very complex premise. This premise may be a little over the heads of a lot of people. This breakdown and its explanation provide some detail, but it is also very cryptic, especially in how it's being played out. It almost comes across as though everything outlined speaks very well to the creator, using

the prose and the breakdown of everything to play out how they see it and how it works in their mind. While that's interesting, it makes it difficult to connect with an immersion and to understand how this will play out dramatically.

The document is very heavily focused on the world-building, which is great. The idea of Bangkok, how it can only be this city, and tying it into the end with everything that the city, the government, and the film and television process in that city plays out. You are clearly an expert in that. You would know exactly what needs to be there to make this work, so building the entire world specifically for Bangkok is very intentional in its presentation.

The idea of this man, who is kind of like a Sherlock Holmes for building and engineering, is unique. It's also unique that this isn't actually a tie character, but a character with ties to other countries. That was unexpected, but it adds a nice layer and elevation, showing this isn't just what we would assume across the board. It's about finding ways to create different kinds of intentions and setting up the characters to load exactly what Met needs to function properly and move through this in an intriguing way.

The document clearly outlines how you see the show working. I'm going to go through each section and focus on how it comes across, what I pick up from it, and the visualization in its cinematic aspect. Because this isn't a pilot and it's designed to showcase people the overall picture of what this is all about, I think it's important that it can connect with anybody who reads it, and that if you go into this document knowing absolutely nothing about the show, this world, and the characters, it's going to either land or confuse. Certain sections are clearer than others, and certain areas make more sense overall once everything is connected.

For full transparency, I was confused the first time I read it, and much of the language and wording made it difficult to move through it seamlessly. That was one of the things that stood out the most on the first read. I had to read it three more times to even partially understand everything and find a way to explain how it landed, what was working effectively, and what was holding me back from not only understanding but also getting excited about what was here.

Starting with the opening of the document, the hook that asks, "What if Sherlock were the mystery?" is interesting because it makes us understand that this show will focus on the main character as the main mystery. I think that's a great way to play it. It also has a great hook: at 8:12 every morning, for exactly one second, the

entire city stops, and he's the only one who can actually see it or pick it up. It makes us wonder why he hasn't said anything to anybody else, why he hasn't tried to figure out what that moment actually means. It then establishes this as a grief story, about what he's lost and how he is moving through this city in a way that keeps breaking him, and he needs to find a way to fix that.

The logline comes next, and it touches on who Met is, what he does, and there's a mystery as well. The idea of buildings that actually shouldn't even be up anymore, should have fallen apart, and are not safe still being there creates an interesting angle for exploration. The idea that, as he moves through this, the city is trying to tell him something about his daughter and how he lost her, or why, adds an interesting element to it. At the same time, it is confusing how the city itself is trying to tell him that, and how these buildings might give him hints or clues about what will lead him to a certain place.

The hook itself then creates more confusion than engagement. It's clear that this is an engineer in Bangkok who investigates buildings, but discovering that the city is trying to tell him something about the daughter he lost is a bit shadowy. It's not really easy to understand until we walk through the second half of this document and grasp what that means. The logline could probably use something different, and I tried to create one up top that's a bit more tangible, as you've probably noticed, but it's something I wanted to point out nonetheless.

In your comp triangle, I really like how you point out and how you set the real patient in House is the doctor. It tells us exactly what Met is in this and how it's going to be pointing to his journey. Severance and its tone definitely set something up in the slow-burning and dread type of situation, and The Sixth Sense is a bit more telling when it comes to the supernatural side of this. The one aspect about having to rewatch it once you understand how everything works is interesting for a movie like The Sixth Sense.

However, it does make it a bit difficult to get excited about a television series that almost requires more than one watch to understand where the episode went and what it was trying to say and do. It speaks to the idea that audiences these days are just not that interested in going back and rewatching something just to understand it, as they are not paying as much attention with a second screen in their hands, and attention spans have shifted.

This is something I'm sure I don't need to go on and on about, but it's the idea of things being clear and easy to understand, and the fear of an audience member looking away for a few seconds and missing something, which then leaves them lost in the episode. That's something I think might worry potential investors and producers. It's great to have a story that is complex and intelligent, and that needs an audience to really think as they move through it.

At the same time, there's a fine line where looking at something with too many secretive or uncertain details that aren't being collected in an investigative way can create a disconnect for an audience. There are so many things out there that can grab our attention, and it's so easy to hit the back button now and try the next series in your queue. That's something that really stood out to me as possibly an issue: having to rewatch two or three times to really pick up on all the juicy tidbits, the fun details, and the information needed to bring it all together.

This aspect, which talks about the city as the diagnostic instrument and the idea of the chime at the 7-Eleven as a blood pressure reading that changes as each episode unfolds, is a bit too cryptic. That's one of the things that makes it a bit difficult to understand the point of all this. It speaks to the idea that each episode in each building, and each thing he learns, takes him deeper into that ethereal space or brings him out of it. It's part of what makes me think that this is all happening in his mind and he's not actually present, but that could just be the assumption that isn't lining up.

Moving on to the next page and the world's build-out, there is a lot going on here that definitely paints a picture. It really does let us know what Thailand is all about, what Bangkok is, and the whole idea of it just being a really messy city, but then once we deepen our experience by being there and moving through it, everything just gets that much deeper.

The angles to do with the static and the coherence field are drawing in some of the other characters and speaking to some of these ideas about what Chloe believes, and to these patterns in the engine of it. Still, it really is overloading us with information, but not clearly enough. I get that it needs to be cryptic and mysterious, but the sentences feel overly complicated: *How he reduces everything to solve both variables, because the alternative is feeling all of it. Every filed case is a filed feeling. Every solved building is an unsolved man.* All of these ideas are hard to wrap the mind around, especially for the average person reading this.

The idea of the engine driving the first five episodes, and then the investigations becoming a liability in six and seven, only to invert in the end, just doesn't really paint a picture of what happens. The episode breakdown later on starts to give us a better idea of what's happening, but at this point, I have to be honest and tell you that I was sitting here having absolutely no idea what this was supposed to be painting for me.

I'm not saying this to be negative or critical in any way. I just want you to know how it might be hitting the average reader who looks at it. When we get to the characters, understanding Met, Ice, Chloe, and Steve is good. I liked the part where you put in the arc about what each character is trying to do and how they are trying to solve everything. It definitely opens things up. The dog being part of it is also interesting because there's always something great about a man and a dog.

The character section could actually be moved earlier to give us a better idea of how they're seeing Met, the world around him, and what part they play in all of it. If that comes before this breakdown of the world and the engine, it might set people up better to get the bigger picture of what elements are all in this.

Once we get to the episode breakdown, it provides a deeper understanding. Some of the scenes that are pointed out are engaging, but at the same time, those episodes don't really give us much. Episode three, for example, tells us about Chloe's mapping of the geography. It mentions the twin sister Kitty and the market investigation, and discusses how Met and Chloe's relationship shifts. Steve showing up in unexpected places gives us a bit more, but it really doesn't help us understand the storyline. The storyline isn't really being touched on in this as much as it is just moments. It just creates this feeling that we're left on the outside a little too much, as though we're almost not allowed to understand enough of what's going on.

It's interesting that you put this scene in from episode five and wrote it not as it would appear in the screenplay, but more so in that prose style of trying to just explain things to us. Using a scene from episode 5 may not be the best approach, since we have no idea what's going on with all these people after five episodes in. Having a scene or scenario from the pilot might be a better choice, so people can understand how the characters are coming to life, how the world is, and how this is all being pieced together.

The visual identity and the way things are broken down are interesting. You have a clear understanding of the vision here, which is great because if you also want to produce this, you can keep hold of it. It picks up the same vibe as something we'd see in *The White Lotus*, with control and each episode playing out in how it looks, feels, and sounds.

The ending talks about why now and more about the production and yourself, rounding this out. It talks about how every detail means something different the second time: the bottle flip, the chime, the dog. It's not exactly clear what you're getting at. Your creator comments are great because they talk about a personal side to this and about trauma, recovery, and healing. That speaks to what the theme of the story is about, and I think it's a great way to end it.

Outro

Overall, as I stated at the top, this is laid out to help you understand how this might hit a potential producing partner or investor. At the end of this, I just wished I had a better understanding of exactly what the storyline is. I understand there are pieces here and there, but again, they're so cryptic and mysterious that it's hard to see how this moves forward, episode by episode.

It's not that the plot has to all be laid out in every detail, but the parts about the wife and the daughter and her showing up more in his emotional or mental state is barely touched on. It could be so much clearer if there were a stronger structure to the story moving forward, and if he picked up the bits and pieces.

It doesn't mean it all has to be given away and lead to this big climax that's fully explained. However, giving more pieces and a better understanding of how the audience becomes engaged in this, and how it is designed to immerse them rather than confuse them or make them feel like they just don't quite understand the supernatural, for a science fiction vibe that is playing out.

It's all about making sure that things are clear, that it's easy to engage with, and that there aren't a whole bunch of questions that come from confusion at the end, rather than questions that speak to excitement and anticipation to see more. If that can be considered, if you are looking to make it more attainable in that regard for

people who know nothing about it going in, it can help take what's here and make it speak to a larger portion of who you may be trying to get this to.

Ratings Grid

	1ST CLASS				SOLID				NOT BAD				NEEDS WORK			
Concept									X							
Story									X							
Structure								X								
Protagonist					X											
Antagonist									X							
Minor Characters					X											
Stakes					X											
Dialogue	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Scenes	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Pacing									X							
Theme	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Originality					X											
World								X								
Tone				X												
Voice							X									

Writing Style						X								
Marketability									X					
Formatting	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Grammar				X										
Title						X								

Script Recommendation

N/A

Got Questions?



You can ask Scott anything! About your script that is... not relationship or financial advice. You can send him your questions by following [this link](#).

(*This link is valid for two weeks.)

Any non-story related questions?



Please don't hesitate to reach out to our executive assistant, Channing Estell, at hello@scriptreaderpro.com
(Quickest replies: Mon - Fri 9am - 5pm PST)

Fade Out

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